

Technical Artist – Jordan Latta

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Professional Summary

Technical Artist with two shipped titles and credit on the *God of War* franchise. Specializes in GPU-driven rendering, shader authoring, and optimization across platforms with a focus on bridging art and engineering pipelines. Solves hard technical problems (custom lighting beyond engine defaults, 1M+ tri grass on Nintendo Switch) while keeping performance impact minimal. Equally comfortable owning a TA pipeline and supporting cross-disciplinary teams throughout production.

Professional Experience

Technical Artist | Mega Cat Studios (2024-Present)

- Owned and built custom GPU-driven rendering systems using C# and Unity's Scriptable Render Pipeline to achieve visuals and performance beyond default engine capabilities.
- Authored, optimized, and maintained shaders, models, materials and textures to serve evolving visual styles and improve performance across platforms.
- Established and documented asset pipelines from creation to management, training up peers and supporting teams throughout production.
- Collaborated with clients, engineers, artists, and designers to build tools — including a grass creation system and 2D light editor — boosting the efficiency of art and engineering pipelines.

God of War: Sons of Sparta | Technical Artist

- Authored a custom 2D lighting system and supporting tool, leveraging Unity's SRP and stencil buffer to give artists 256 lit sprite layers.
- Built the core sprite shader suite underpinning environments and characters, taking advantage of static batching and GPU instancing to optimize draw call count on PS5.
- Developed 13 shaders and materials for key environment visuals including swaying foliage, pixel-perfect running water, reflections, and dynamic lights.
- Maintained and evolved the lighting system and tool throughout production, serving a team of 20+ lighting artists.

Backyard Baseball | Technical Artist

- Headed R&D to develop a lightweight GPU-driven grass renderer handling 1M+ tris in one draw call — using async GPU compute, custom data structures, and Nvidia Nsight Graphics to minimize performance impact across platforms.
- Combined environment asset meshes, materials, and textures to fit within memory budgets on Nintendo Switch, reducing batch count by 50% and memory usage by 75%.
- Mentored peers on lighting workflows, asset integration, and optimization techniques throughout production.

Education

Michigan State University | B.A. in Games & Interactive Media (2019-2023)

Minor in Game Design & Development

Skills

- Unity (C#, Universal Render Pipeline/Scriptable Render Pipeline)
- Unreal Engine 5 (Learning)
- Shader Development (HLSL, Shader Graph, Unreal Engine Blueprints)
- Performance Optimization
- Performance Profiling (Unity Profiler, RenderDoc, Nvidia Nsight)
- PBR Workflow & Material Pipeline
- VFX & GPU Particle systems
- Real-Time Rendering
- 3D Modeling, UV Mapping, Rendering (Blender)
- Animation, Rigging fundamentals (Maya)
- Real-Time Lighting & Global Illumination
- Level of Detail (LOD)
- Compute Shaders
- Photoshop
- Git

Hobbies

- Computer Hardware/Architecture
- Culinary Arts & Food Science
- Foraging & Fermentation
- Digital Art
- Piano (self-taught)

Languages

- English
- German